CIG CONCEPTS · CATERING & EVENTS

Community Outreach

Standard Operating Procedure · Department: Catering & Events · Position: Catering & Events Manager

Every location grows one neighbor at a time. Catering & Events managers get to know the schools, businesses, churches and teams around their restaurant, visit them, follow up, and turn that interest into catering orders and events. Every visit is logged in the Hub so the COO can see the work and stay in touch with prospective clients.

DATE	DEPARTMENT	POSITION
Posted Oct 26, 2026	Catering & Events	Catering & Events Manager

PROCEDURE

STEP	ACTION
Step 1	**Know your area.** List the places around your restaurant worth knowing: schools, churches, businesses and offices, hotels, apartment complexes, military, sports leagues and nonprofits. Add each one in the Hub (Catering › Outreach › + Add place) with a contact and its bucket.
Step 2	**Plan your week.** Start with the places the Hub shows as Follow-up due, then pick a few new ones. Group visits by area so one trip covers several stops.
Step 3	**Pack the drop-off.** Every visit leaves something behind: a catering menu and a business card at minimum. A gift card or a sample tray only with your GM's approval. Add a short handwritten note.
Step 4	**Make the visit.** Introduce yourself and the restaurant. Ask for the person who plans meetings, events or fundraisers. Learn what they have coming up and what they usually order. Keep it short and friendly.
Step 5	**Log it the same day.** In the Hub, open the place and tap + Log a visit: what happened, who you spoke to, what you left. The next follow-up sets itself a month out; change it if they asked you to come back sooner.
Step 6	**Follow up.** The Hub emails you the morning a follow-up is due. Go back or call, and bring something new: a seasonal menu, a sample, an invitation to an upcoming event.
Step 7	**Turn interest into business.** When they want catering or an event, tap Turn into catering enquiry. It opens a new enquiry with their details filled in; claim it and work it as normal. The place shows Booked once the enquiry is confirmed.
Step 8	**Plan community events.** Fundraisers, school nights, festivals and runs go under Planned community events, with the contact, date and expected headcount. Afterwards, record how many came.

TRAINING POINTS

- Every partnership should fit one of the four buckets. If it doesn't, look for a way to say yes anyway: they are still a customer, and a "not now" can become a booking later.
- Never promise a donation, discount, sponsorship or free food without your GM's or the COO's approval.
- Keep contact names, numbers and emails current in the Hub. Whoever covers for you works from what is there.
- Read the notes on each place before you go. The COO and executives leave notes there for you.
- Be a good neighbor first. The goal is a relationship, not a sale on the first visit.

Community Outreach: Reference

THE FOUR BUCKETS

Every place in the Hub, and every event you plan, is filed under one bucket. It shows where the work is going and where the gaps are.

BUCKET	WHAT IT COVERS	IDEAS
Fundraising	Raising money for a cause, together	Dine-to-donate nights, donated gift cards for auctions, sponsorships, charity events, church and nonprofit drives
Schools	Schools, colleges and their families	Teacher appreciation lunches, PTO and booster events, honor-roll rewards, reading programs, college department and student meals
Sports	Teams, leagues and athletic events	Team meals and banquets, league sponsorships, 5Ks and charity runs, tournament catering, athletic department events
Neighborhood	Everyone else close by	New businesses, offices and their meetings, hotels and front desks, apartment and new-home communities, military, first responders, farmers markets

GOOD REASONS TO VISIT

- Welcome a new business that just opened nearby.
- Introduce an existing business to catering and large-party orders.
- Show a school every way we can partner through the year.
- Ask a hotel to keep menus at the front desk and to include us in the events they host.
- Welcome new home buyers through the neighborhood or HOA office.
- Thank a fire station, police department or military unit.

THE DROP-OFF

Always	Catering menu, business card, short handwritten note
With GM approval	Gift card, sample tray, invitation to a tasting or event
For events	Sign-up sheet or card for follow-up contacts, menus for the table

IN THE HUB

CATERING & EVENTS MANAGER	COO	FOLLOW-UP EMAIL
Adds places, logs every visit the same day, plans community events, turns interest into catering enquiries.	Reviews every location's outreach, sets a monthly visit goal per location, and leaves notes on places.	Arrives at 7:47am the day a follow-up is due, listing each place to revisit.

TASK CERTIFICATIONS

Catering & Events Manager Certification	Name / Date
COO Review	Name / Date